

BEING A MAKER

DIY genius or an entrepreneur with
the right tools – what does it really
mean to be a maker?

I think frugality drives innovation, just like other constraints do. One of the only ways to get out of a tight box is to invent your way out.

-Jeff Bezos

Whenever we hear the term ‘maker’, it is unavoidable to think of the act of creation. But the maker which we have been hearing of recently is more than just an inventor. In fact, a maker is something completely different. The textbook definition says, a maker is an individual who creates a new product out of seemingly ordinary or easy to access materials. Being a maker entails a lot more than that. It is inextricably linked to being part of a community. The entire rise of the DIY and maker culture has been due to the widespread reach of the internet. The idea of being a maker has its roots in the idea of arts and crafts. Taking things which are available, taking a problem that needs to be solved or an idea that needs to be shared, using methods that are accessible to even the most inexperienced and ill-equipped people—all these constitute the process of “Making”. Before you get overwhelmed, let us first understand what separates a maker from the rest of the world.